SUNIL GAUTAM

ENGINEERING LEAD (Player-Coach) • React / Node.js / TypeScript • GraphQL / PostgreSQL • AI-Assisted Dev

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Hands-on Engineering Lead with 13+ years building production full-stack applications and leading small engineering teams as a **player-coach** — ~60% hands-on (coding, technical design, architecture, code reviews, testing, troubleshooting) and the rest on coaching, delivery, and cross-functional leadership. Advanced with **JavaScript/TypeScript, Node.js, React, GraphQL, and PostgreSQL**, and a strong, day-to-day user of **Claude and AI-assisted development** — modelling and coaching AI practices to improve velocity, code quality, testing, and documentation. Owns engineering quality with a **shift-left testing mindset**, drives sound architecture and API/distributed-systems design, mentors engineers, leads sprint execution, and takes ownership of production outcomes in secure, agile teams.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Core Stack: TypeScript, JavaScript (ES6+), Node.js, Express.js, React.js, Next.js, GraphQL, REST APIs, PostgreSQL

AI-Assisted Development: Claude & AI-assisted engineering — coding, testing, code review, debugging, documentation; coaching teams on effective AI workflows

Architecture: API Design, Application Architecture, Distributed Systems, Microservices, Event-Driven Design, Scalable/Reliable/Secure Systems, Technical Debt Management

Quality & Testing: Shift-Left Quality, Automated Testing (unit/integration/system/E2E), Jest, Code Reviews, Test Coverage Standards, Defect Prevention

Delivery & Cloud: Git/PRs, CI/CD (Bitbucket), AWS (EC2, S3, RDS, CloudWatch), Observability/Monitoring, Production Support & Incident Response, Agile/Scrum

Leadership: Player-Coach Team Leadership, 1:1s & Coaching, Mentoring, Sprint Planning & Estimation, Cross-Functional Collaboration (Product/Design/QA/Security)

Databases: PostgreSQL, MongoDB, MySQL, Data-Intensive Application Design, Data Modeling, Query Optimization

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Team Lead / Engineering Lead (Player-Coach) — HKK Entertainment Private Limited
Jan 2024 – Present

React.js, Next.js, TypeScript, Node.js, Express.js, GraphQL, MongoDB, REST APIs, AWS, CI/CD, Jest

- Player-coach for a team of 6+ engineers while staying **~60% hands-on** — design, code, architecture, reviews, testing, and troubleshooting on **Zillit**, an enterprise SaaS platform.
- Own complex, architecturally significant work; translate product requirements into secure, scalable, maintainable solutions and lead technical design/architecture reviews.
- **Model and coach Claude / AI-assisted development** across the team — using AI for coding, test generation, reviews, debugging, and docs to lift velocity and quality.
- Drive **shift-left quality**: code reviews, automated tests, and coverage standards; reject PRs lacking adequate tests; reduce defects and improve deployment confidence.
- Lead sprint planning, estimation, refinement, and retrospectives; run 1:1s, mentor engineers, and remove blockers; take ownership of production outcomes and incident response.

Consultant Project Leader / Senior Engineer — R Systems International
May 2021 – Dec 2023

Node.js, React.js, TypeScript, PostgreSQL, AWS (RDS, CloudWatch), Bitbucket, CI/CD

- Hands-on technical lead for **IATF (CIBC)**, a secure healthcare-grade-rigor banking platform — designed and built Node.js transaction APIs with audit logging, validation, and authorization on **PostgreSQL**.
- Operated production systems on AWS with **CloudWatch observability**; led CI/CD via Bitbucket, code reviews, quality gates, and production troubleshooting/root-cause analysis.
- Mentored engineers and led delivery of **WorkfloPlus**, a mobile-first SaaS platform.

Technical Solution Architect — Shivkaal Infotech Pvt. Ltd.
Sep 2020 – May 2021

Node.js, Express.js, PostgreSQL, GraphQL, REST APIs

- Led architecture and end-to-end delivery of **Krishak Fresh**, a data-intensive e-commerce platform; designed **GraphQL/REST APIs** and normalized **PostgreSQL** schemas for scalability.
- Made technical tradeoff decisions across performance, security, and maintainability; implemented secure, role-based backend architecture.

Senior Software Engineer — STPL
Sep 2018 – Sep 2020

Node.js, Express.js, MySQL, REST APIs, Ionic, Angular

- Built Node.js REST backends and apps for enterprise facility management; optimised APIs, caching, and reliability; mentored engineers and troubleshot production issues.

Software Engineer — Singsys Pte Ltd
Jan 2012 – Aug 2018

Node.js, JavaScript, MySQL, REST APIs, Angular

- Built **Tueetor**, a marketplace platform — full-stack frontend plus backend REST APIs; collaborated with designers and engineers in Agile teams.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Zillit — Enterprise SaaS (Player-Coach Lead). React/Next.js + Node.js/GraphQL platform with shift-left testing, AI-assisted workflow (Claude), and secure architecture on AWS.

IATF — Instant Access to Deposited Funds (CIBC). Secure, high-reliability banking backend with Node.js APIs, PostgreSQL, audit logging, and production observability.

Krishak Fresh. Data-intensive e-commerce platform with GraphQL/REST APIs and normalized PostgreSQL, architected end to end.

EDUCATION

MCA — Master of Computer Applications, Uttar Pradesh Technical University (UPTU), 2012

BCA — Computer Applications, Bhopal University, 2009

ADDITIONAL

Experience: 13+ years • **Location:** Lucknow, India — Remote • **Notice:** < 15 days • **Languages:** English, Hindi